

JOHN NZIOKI NZIVO

Team Lead | Solutions Engineer | Executive MBA | Systems Architect

Nairobi, Kenya | +254 717 058 930 | johnnnzivo@gmail.com | nzivo.github.io

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Fintech engineer and systems architect with 7 years building lending platforms, payment gateways, and cross-border money transfer systems used across Africa. I've led engineering teams, architected Mpesa and remittance integrations, and served as both hands-on developer and technical governance lead.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

TECHNOLOGY & SYSTEMS MANAGER – Consultant

UMSUKA CAPITAL KENYA & GHANA – Nairobi, Kenya

DECEMBER 2024 – PRESENT

- Managing internal systems: A payment gateway, an AML system and Salary processing + lending platform.
- Collaborating with external shareholders on meetings and training especially the central bank and credit lenders at the Kenya School of monetary Studies.
- Architecting and overseeing integration of The Central Bank of Kenya Granular Data Integration System.
- Developing security policies and enforcing them.
- Architecting and overseeing development of a salary processing system for civil servants.
- Coordinating team meeting between Safaricom, HRIS (public Service) and Umsuka Capital on a range of projects.
- Participation on the draft National Payment System Policy and National Payment System Bill 2026

SENIOR FULLSTACK ENGINEER – Full Time

ROAMTECH SOLUTIONS LIMITED – Nairobi City, Kenya

MARCH 2025 – AUGUST 2026

- Co-architected Senti, a lending platform and been the lead developer on several features to assist ease lending to our customers.
- Developed lending through WhatsApp as a service
- Architectured and developed Senti Salary Advance dashboard, backend and a USSD service for customers
- Revamped the admin dashboard for commercial processes and reconciliation
- Architectured and developed a mobile payments gateway to handle Mpesa disbursements and receipts of customer payments.
- Created a sanction screening service for the MLRO team
- Revamped UI sections for Paykit merchant portal

FULLSTACK ENGINEER – Contractor

PRODUCTIVE SOFTWARE – Tel Aviv, Israel

OCTOBER 2023 – SEPTEMBER 2024

- I developed an e-commerce platform, [Safsar X](#) to enable resell of tickets.
- Set up amazon Web services to serve.
- Integrated Tranzila payment gateway.
- Set up GitHub pipelines and Jira workflows for Safsar X.
- I build a [firebase file management](#) prototype system for a legal firm.

LEAD ENGINEER – Full Time

ROAMTECH SOLUTIONS LIMITED – Nairobi City, Kenya

SEPTEMBER 2022 – October 2023

- I was promoted to be lead developer and system architect of [Afrisend Money transfer](#), an International Money Transfer system. I led a team of seven developers who include two mobile developers, one frontend developer and four backend developers.

SENIOR FRONTEND ENGINEER MAY

2022 – SEPTEMBER 2023

- Designed and developed the reporting module for Afrisend Money Transfer to CBK, Teller and Till Modules and refined the send money process while revamping the UI.
- Integrated 6 corridors to our backend: MFS Africa; congo, Nigeria, Ghana, Instantcash; Dubai, curfex; Japan, Goolpay; USA.
- Rewrote [mtickets backend](#) in fastapi, increasing sales and event management by over 80% and streamline operations.
- Designed the backend and database architecture for the mtickets backend.
- Wrote a [client frontend end](#) to support resellers in Vue and Nuxt JS for emalify sms platform.

DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS OFFICER - WEBMASTER & DESIGN – Full Time

STRATHMORE UNIVERSITY – Nairobi City, Kenya

MAY 2021 – APRIL 2022

As Webmaster at Strathmore University, I served as the primary Product Manager, Systems Architect, and technical lead across the university's digital ecosystem. In this dual capacity, I drove end-to-end web strategy by architecting scalable internal systems while providing rigorous technical governance over high-stakes external vendor projects to ensure security, brand consistency, and operational alignment.

- **Internal Systems Architecture:** Led end-to-end product development for core internal platforms, including the School of Tourism and Hospitality site, the Strathmore Exhibition portal, the Events and Protocol website, and central research environments (Research Portal & Research Website).
- **External Vendor Management:** Served as technical lead and product owner for major third-party builds, directing agency deliverables for the flagship Strathmore University flagship website overhaul and the School of Humanities and Social Sciences platform.

- **Technical Governance & Operations:** Established institutional UI/UX design standards, defined system architecture specs, and managed routine infrastructure performance across all academic web properties.

EDUCATION

EXECUTIVE PROGRAM IN MANAGEMENT & BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT, TECHNOLOGY AND FINANCE - LISBON, PORTUGAL - 2026

Specialized training in strategic business management, financial planning, enterprise leadership, and technology innovation management.

BSC. COMPUTER SCIENCE, SECOND CLASS HONOURS – 2015 – 2019

MERU UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY - MERU, KENYA

Rigorous training in software development, algorithms, and system design, alongside practical expertise in UI/UX and multimedia tools (Adobe Creative Cloud). This core degree laid the technical foundation for my evolution into a full-stack engineer and payment solutions architect, specializing in secure transaction infrastructure, complex API integrations, and scalable web systems.

School Project:

- [Blockchain application in Ethereum for Land Purchase in Kenya](#). Used React JavaScript for User Interface, Solidity for backend, Mongo DB in Loopback for my data management and Node.js to manage the project structure.

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

1. **Project Management:** Extensive experience in managing projects using Agile methodology and the Jira management tool. Proficient in Product Lifecycle Management, User-Centred Design, Market Research, and Competitive Analysis, Product Road mapping, and MVP Development.
2. **UX/UI Design:** Expert in creating user-friendly prototypes using Adobe XD and Figma. Proficient in web design, Photoshop, and Illustrator.
3. **Front End Development:** Highly skilled in developing responsive and dynamic front-end applications using React, Vue.js, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Sass, and native CSS.
4. **Back End and REST API Development:** Strong foundation in developing REST APIs using Spring and Laravel frameworks. Proficient in software architecture design, API design and management, performance tuning and optimization.
5. **Systems and Enterprise Programming:** Extensive programming experience in PHP, C#, Java, TypeScript, Python, and JavaScript. Proficient in developing and maintaining enterprise applications.
6. **Version Control and CI/CD:** Proficient in using GIT, GitHub, GitLab for version control. Experienced with Jenkins, CircleCI, and other CI/CD tools for continuous integration and delivery. Familiar with legacy deployment tools, cloud tooling, and container orchestration.

7. **Database Management:** Proficient in SQL, MySQL, PostgreSQL, and MongoDB. Experience in database design, optimization, and management.
8. **Security and Compliance:** Knowledgeable in cybersecurity analysis, penetration testing and vulnerability assessment.
9. **Advanced Technical Skills:** Expertise in cloud architecture (AWS and Google Cloud Platform), microservices architecture, DevOps practices, serverless computing, edge computing, AI and machine learning integration, blockchain technology, and security architecture and design.
10. **Containerization and Virtualization:** Proficient in containerization using Docker and OS virtualization with Hyper-V. Experience in managing containerized applications and container orchestration.
11. **Android Development:** Strong knowledge of Android development using Android Studio and Java.
12. **Software Development:** Skilled in software development practices including Test-Driven Development (TDD), Behavior-Driven Development (BDD), and performance tuning. Experience in developing, deploying, integrating, maintaining, monitoring, and operating software on CI/CD architecture for on-premises and multi-cloud infrastructure.
13. **Legacy Code Management:** Experienced in reviewing and repairing legacy code, conducting system analysis and development to keep systems current with changing technologies. Capable of analyzing current programs, diagnosing and troubleshooting problems, and designing solutions.
14. **System Analysis and Design:** Ability to analyze system specifications, translate system requirements into task specifications, and supervise the development of software systems for information processing solutions.
15. **Program Development and Debugging:** Proficient in writing, editing, and debugging new computer programs for assigned projects. Skilled in developing new programs and ensuring the production of quality software products.
16. **Automation and Monitoring:** Experience with automation, integration, monitoring, and system integration tools and practices.

CONFERENCES & CERTIFICATIONS

UDEMY

- **Decision-Making Strategies for Leaders**, *Issued on August 12, 2026*
- **RabbitMQ In Practice**, *Issued on March 23, 2026*
- **AI for Business - AI Applications for Business Success**, *Issued on September 1, 2025*
- **Vue - The Complete Guide (incl. Router & Composition API)**, *Issued on October 1, 2023*
- **Advanced CSS and Sass: Flexbox, Grid, Animations and More!**, *Issued on April 16, 2022*

CRESTRON TRAINING INSTITUTE

- Crestron Core Certificate, Credential No: CCT-333-210111-1919

- Crestron Design Tool Certificate, Credential No: CDT-000-210119-2249
- International Computer Driving License, Credential No: KE 1335092

NAIROBI INNOVATION WEEK 2018 - UNESCO MOBILE APPLICATION DEVELOPMENT HACKATHON.

- Presented an application, Soko Tamu, which served to connect farmers to the markets cutting out unscrupulous middlemen to maximise returns to the farmer with Ignatius Mbugua.

REFERENCES

- Felista Gachau, Roamtech Solutions Limited, Head of People and Culture, +254 751 567 962, felista.gachau@roamtech.com,
- Lee Mbugua, Network International, Head of Architecture, +254 797 561 830, lee.mbugua@network.global,
- Prof. Ismail Ateya, Strathmore University, Director Office of Faculty Affairs, +254 703 034 000, iateya@strathmore.edu

HOBBIES

- Painting, Hiking, playing football and swimming.
- Designing Concepts.
- Bike riding
- Fitness